

debt, follow my advice in this book and become debt-free as soon as you can. Then, move on to the next steps toward financial security: saving and investing.

I hope your money problems aren't so dire that you need a program and a sponsor. But I still want you to think of me as your Money Sponsor, someone who has been through the thick of it, who has experienced economic insecurity and has come out the other end thriving. My qualifications for being your Money Sponsor have nothing to do with having money. They have to do with my fundamental philosophies around building wealth. I have not created my wealth because I am special or different. I have never believed a lottery ticket or an inheritance will save the day.

You got through Part One, you found your 90-Day Number, you gave honest answers to some tough questions about your spending, saving, and investing, you know what it will take to live within your means, and you are ready to begin setting aside money to save and perhaps invest. Now it's time to commit, folks.

Take the money pledge below. Don't just read it, sign it. This is your promise—to yourself, to your loved ones, and to me, your Money Sponsor—that you will abide by the principles of value, discipline, and security, with an eye to improving your financial life.

Money Pledge

1. I will take a cold hard look at my current financial situation, using the ninety-day money model outlined previously in this book. I'm going to put my financial life on paper so I know exactly where I stand, because knowledge is the first step toward empowerment.
2. I will get my taxes, receipts, W-2s, bills, and insurance forms in order. I'll buy a few folders, label them, and start organizing all my financial papers so I have easy access to them.
3. I will get everyone who is contributing financially to my household involved in this process, including my partner or